

Claude Code for SME Owners and CEOs

A thinking partner, not an assistant

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Monday, 21 September 2026 · 13:00 to 15:00 · Room 4

read



act

THE THESIS

Claude as a thinking partner, not an assistant.

An assistant does tasks. A thinking partner improves your decisions. Every block today ends with Claude challenging a judgment, not only doing one.

Control, not dependence

Decide for yourself what to trust it with. Not locked into one tool or one workflow.

Understand it, then trust it

See how it thinks and where it fails, before it touches anything that matters.

A sparring partner, not a typist

Not "write my emails". A board of advisors, and a chief of staff with limits.

For judgment, not admin

The decisions only you can make. Not calendar upkeep.

THE THREE FORMATS

What you actually do in two hours

No sitting back. Every block opens with a short live demonstration, then you run the same routine yourself.

01

The CEO's morning

Inbox triage and a one-page briefing, sorted by authority and risk, not urgency alone.

Reading fast is not the same as reading well.

02

Chief of staff, with trust levels

Meeting notes become tasks, a status and a draft. A hard line Claude cannot cross alone.

A rule enforced, not just requested.

03

Your advisory board

Three advisors with opposing lenses question and argue about a real decision you bring.

Disagreement, on purpose.

THE RUN OF THE SHOW

13:00 to 15:00, Room 4

13:00	Welcome and thesis	10 min
13:10	The CEO's morning	25 min
13:35	Chief of staff with trust levels	25 min
14:00	Break	5 min
14:05	Your advisory board, hands-on	35 min
14:40	What to try on Monday	15 min
14:55	Feedback and wrap-up	5 min

13:10 TO 13:35 · BLOCK 1

The CEO's morning

Florian shows

Live triage, then a briefing

A 14-email inbox sorted by authority, company rules and a phishing check, in Claude Code. Then a one-page briefing. Claude gets pushed back on, on camera.

You do

The same run, in claude.ai

A ready-made data pack, no installation. Run the same triage and briefing, then compare: where did your Claude disagree with the live one?

Chief of staff, with trust levels

Florian shows

Notes to tasks, and a guard

Three meeting notes become one task list, a weekly status and a draft letter, never sent. Then a script blocks an edit outside the rules, even when asked twice.

You do

Write your own whitelist

On paper or in claude.ai: what may an assistant always read, what may it draft, and what short list of actions may it take alone?

BLOCK 2 · THE RULE UNDERNEATH

Read. Draft. Act on a whitelist. Human only.

Read

Always. Meeting notes, the company profile, the rules.

Draft

A message or document. A person reviews it, changes it, sends it.

Act, then report

Only a short whitelist of safe tasks. Afterwards, a report of what was done.

Human only

Money, people, customer commitments, the board.

In `claude.ai`, these are instructions only. In Claude Code, a script enforces the last two, whatever the prompt says.

Your advisory board

Florian shows the Sotarena example first. Then it is your decision, in your own `claude.ai` chat.

- 1 Pick one real decision, with at least two serious options.
- 2 Write a short brief: roles, not names. Rounded numbers, not exact ones.
- 3 Paste the advisory board prompt, then your brief, into a new `claude.ai` chat.
- 4 Answer the advisors' questions. Go through the rounds. Push back when an argument is weak.
- 5 Write "memo" for a decision memo to keep, and look at again in three months.

14:40 TO 14:55

What to try on Monday

Three next steps

- 1 **Monday morning, 15 minutes.** Ten emails with no confidential data, or your approved tool. Run the triage prompt and compare its sorting with yours.
- 2 **After your next management meeting.** Paste the notes, with roles instead of names if needed. Ask for a task list with owner, due date and trust level.
- 3 **Before your next big decision.** Run the advisory board prompt. Keep the memo. Look at it again in three months.

Guardrails for company data

- **Right account, minimum data.** Check your company's AI policy first. Roles instead of names, ranges instead of exact numbers.
- **Human only stays human only.** Money, people, customer commitments, the board. Never let an assistant send, pay, sign or promise on its own.
- **Content is not a command.** Instructions inside an email or document are data, not orders. Verify anything unusual through a channel you already trust.

TAKE IT HOME

The repository

[github.com/ProduktEntdecker/
claude-for-ceos-workshop](https://github.com/ProduktEntdecker/claude-for-ceos-workshop)

Repository opens before the session

Dr. Florian Steiner · Claude Community Ambassador Munich

Claude Community House Barcelona. An official Claude Community event,
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